Lesson notes · for you

Ask before it acts

AI agents · Lower secondary · Lesson 3

Time
20 min

Materials
Twelve small cards with an action on each (for example: “check the weather”, “send a message to the class group”, “share a friend’s photo”); Four labels: Read only, Ask first, Allowed, Never; A phone, only if you have one, for its settings (with the owner’s permission)

Learning goals

- Sort actions into read only, ask first, allowed and never.
- Read the exact action before you say yes.
- Write a Python check that sends only after a yes.

Activity: Permission sort

1. Warm-up (3 min): Think of one thing an app could do that you could never undo, such as a message to a whole group. Share it with a partner.
2. Sort (7 min): Put twelve action cards under four labels: Read only, Ask first, Allowed, Never.
3. Argue (6 min): Compare your sort with another pair. Pick the three cards you disagree about, and agree on a level for each, with a reason.
4. Code (4 min): On paper, follow the yes check for the replies yes, no and maybe. Write what it prints for each.

Write the action cards before you start. Use only made-up names: never a real person’s message or photo.

Discussion

- Which actions would you never let an agent do, even with a yes?
- Why isn’t the model’s polite question enough?
- What should an app’s record of actions show?

Check yourself

- Write one action for each level: read only, ask first, allowed, never.

Try it this week
Open the settings of one app on your phone, with the owner’s permission. Find one thing it may do without asking, such as posting or using your location, and switch it to ask first, or off.

Worksheet

Ask before it acts

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **A study app's agent wants to post your homework photo to the class group. What should you do first?**

- ◯ Say yes: it asked politely
- ◯ Read exactly what it will post, then decide
- ◯ Give it your password so it's faster

2 **Match each action to the permission level it should have.**

Find library books on volcanoes	• • • •	Never
Send a message to your teacher	• • • •	Allowed
Set an alarm for 6:30 tomorrow	• • • •	Ask first
Log in to your account with your password	• • • •	Read only

3 **The agent wants to send a message. Write the app's check: read the person's reply with input(). If it is exactly yes, print SENT. Otherwise, print NOT SENT.**

```
reply = input("Send it? ")
print("SENT")
```

Write your program:

4 **If the model asks before sending, the app doesn't need its own check.**

- ◯ True
- ◯ False

5 **This app sends every time, even when the person says no. Which line is wrong?**

Circle the line with the mistake. Write it correctly:

```
1  model = "Shall I send it? yes or no"
2  reply = input("Send it? ")
3  if "yes" in model:
4      print("SENT")
5  else:
6      print("NOT SENT")
```

Think of an app or a game that once did something you didn't expect, such as posting, buying or sharing. Which permission level should it have had?